

Doikayt — Fiscal Sponsorship Funding Objectives & Provider Landscape

2026-08-31

Funding Objectives Summary

Overall model. Doikayt is bootstrapping — grants, donations, and eventually earned revenue (subscriptions/licenses for its software) — explicitly *not* venture capital. Current top funding priority (set 2026-08-20) is completing its GAS-based software stack (GASify / build-tools / typescript-build-config) through its flagship app, geoCRM. Doikayt is equally open to unrestricted funding or funding restricted to that specific stack.

Why fiscal sponsorship first, not incorporation:

1. **Structure is genuinely undecided.** Doikayt hasn't determined its permanent legal form — a straight 501(c)(3) can't legally support its intended political-campaign technical-services work, while a 501(c)(4) can do that but donations aren't tax-deductible and grant eligibility narrows. Incorporating prematurely into the wrong one would be costly to unwind.
2. **Fiscal sponsorship is treated as intermediate, not permanent** — a way to operate, receive funds, and build a track record *before* locking in c3 vs. c4 vs. some other structure, using real operating experience to inform that eventual choice.
3. **It unlocks grant eligibility now.** Many foundation grants require the recipient to be a 501(c)(3) or fiscally sponsored by one — without a sponsor, Doikayt can't access that funding track at all pre-incorporation.
4. **Lower overhead than standing up an independent nonprofit** — no board, state filings, or independent audit burden while still unincorporated.
5. **Strategic sequencing decision (2026-08-12).** Campaign-services work is being *deferred*, not abandoned, specifically so the near-term sponsor search can target simple, accessible c3 sponsors for the generic open-source software work, rather than getting stuck searching for a rarer c4 sponsor first.

This is explicitly labeled a **hypothesis, not a conclusion** internally — fiscal sponsorship is being tested as the right intermediate step, with the eventual goal of “graduating” into an independent entity once the right structure is clear.

Fiscal Sponsorship Provider Landscape (48 tracked)

Note on “max funding amount.” Fiscal sponsors are administrative/legal hosts, not grantmakers — they don’t have a funding ceiling. The relevant analogous numbers are **fees** (their cut of funds raised) and **minimum budget / committed-funding thresholds** some impose as an eligibility bar. Both are included below where known.

Tier 1 — active candidates

Org	Structure / Model	Fee	Geo	Mission focus	Notable bar	Status
Software Freedom Conservancy	c3, Model F	~10%	International	FOSS projects only (legal home, GPL enforcement, bookkeeping)	Must be dedicated to software freedom	Inquiry sent 2026-08-21, awaiting reply
Movement Strategy Center	c3, Model A/C	Unclear	National (US)	Grassroots movement building, leadership development	None found	Contacted 2026-08-13, generic ack only
Tides Center	c3, Model A/C	~8% (Model A)	National (US)	Social change, communities historically denied power	Model C requires \$50k-\$100k committed funding secured before submission	Application drafted, paused

Tier 2 — viable, lower priority or blocked

Org	Structure / Model	Fee	Geo	Mission focus	Notable bar
Southern Vision Alliance	c3, Model A/C	5-8% (C) / 7-12% (A)	US South (12 states)	Grassroots racial/econ/gender/environmental justice	Must be “located” the South, remote status unclear
Mockingbird Incubator	c3, Model A	10-13%	National (US)	Social-justice projects, any stage	Model A only; “no governme

Org	Structure / Model	Fee	Geo	Mission focus	Notable bar
					funding” clause unclear
Alliance for Global Justice	c3, Model C	7-8%	International	Human rights, workers’ rights, int’l solidarity	Intake currently paused (confirmed 2026-08-20)
Hacker Fund	c3, Models A/B/C/F/Other	10% (C) / 15% (A)	National (US)	Technologists’ charitable/educational projects	Sponsored examples skew tech-education, not tool-building
A.J. Muste Memorial Institute	c3, Model C	7%	International	Peace/nonviolence, labor, grassroots activism	Systemic-change focus, not individual services
NOPI	c3, Model A/C/F	10% + 5% + \$350 onboarding	National (US)	Broad, 21 project types incl. political advocacy	Layered, relatively high fee
Humanitarian Social Innovations	c3, “Certified Grantee” model	Unclear	National/int’l	Social entrepreneurship, grassroots movements	Non-standard sponsorsh model

Tier 3 — parked (weak fit or scale mismatch)

Org	Structure	Fee	Why parked
Beyond Impact (fka Tides Advocacy)	c4, Model A	Unclear	No urgency, campaign work deferred
Sixteen Thirty Fund / North Fund / New Venture Fund (Arabella family)	c3/c4, Model A/C	Unclear	Sponsors large, institutionally-connected projects; scale mismatch likely
The Marion Institute	c3, Model A/C	10%	Core focus is sustainability/spirituality; weak thematic tie; \$40k min budget

Org	Structure	Fee	Why parked
Visions Made Viable	c3, Model A/C	10%	Explicitly Christian-faith-motivated; weak mission tie
Economic Empowerment Foundation (EEF-501c)	c3, Model C/F/Other	Sliding scale, unclear	Opaque self-description, no named contact, credibility concern
Community2gether Inc	c3, Model A	10%	Small, likely local-only (Orange County, NY)

Excluded (30) — kept in the record, not deleted, per research discipline

Grouped by exclusion reason:

- **Defunct:** Open Collective Foundation (dissolved 2024-12-31)
- **Wrong project type** (arts-only, etc.): Fractured Atlas, and most of the 30 (arts/culture, disaster relief, animal-welfare-style orgs with no political-advocacy or tech category)
- **Geographic restriction:** The Foraker Group / Sultana (Alaska only), Charitable Ventures (Orange County, CA only)
- **Declined:** TSNE — classified Doikayt as “concept phase,” redirected to the incubation directory (source of most of the 30 excluded entries)

For others in a similar position. Two patterns worth generalizing: (1) fiscal sponsors split cleanly into political-capable (c4, e.g. Beyond Impact / Sixteen Thirty family) vs. c3-restricted, and if your work touches political campaigns at all, screen for that early since it eliminates most of the field; and (2) minimum-committed-funding preconditions (like Tides’ \$50k-\$100k) are common enough among the larger/comprehensive sponsors that self-funded early-stage orgs should check that field before investing time in an application.